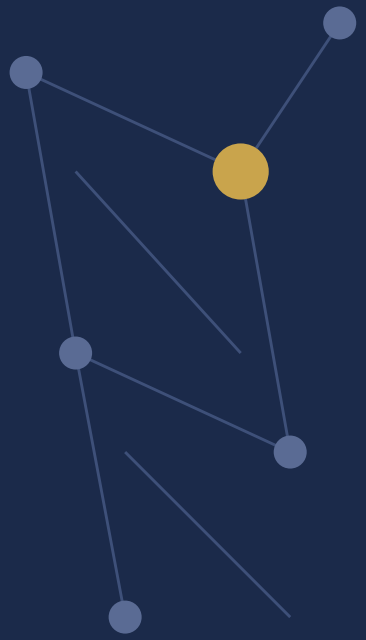
From Prompting to Context Engineering

Better AI output begins with better instructional context

Week 3 · Professor Miran Kim

Course Session



What You'll Leave With Today

1. Understand why context is not more information — it's the right information for the decision.

2. Apply seven elements of instructional context to any AI request.

3. Turn a generic prompt into an instructional brief before generating anything.

This is proactive design — the bridge to Week 4's HTML literacy.

0–10 MIN · WEEK 2 RECALL

Where Did the Better Redirection Come From?

✗ *"Make the feedback better."*

✓ *"When a learner gives an incorrect answer, do not immediately show the correct answer. First provide a semantic hint and allow one retry. After the second incorrect attempt, show the answer with a brief explanation."*

Is the second one better just because it's longer? "No."

We also saw it inside the code: a function can carry a pedagogical decision.

Good prompting begins with good pedagogical decisions.

Reactive Judgment → Proactive Design

Before

What is wrong with this AI output, and how should I redirect it?

After

What should I tell AI before it generates the activity?

10–25 MIN · TWO DIFFERENT QUESTIONS

Prompt Engineering vs. Context Engineering

PROMPT ENGINEERING

How should I phrase my request?

- "Act as an English teacher."
- "Give me step-by-step output."
- "Use a table."
- "Be concise."
- "Think carefully."

CONTEXT ENGINEERING

What does AI need to know to make a pedagogically appropriate decision?

Prompt phrasing can help. It does not guarantee good teaching.

What Changed From A to C?

A *“Make a vocabulary activity.”*

B *“Make an engaging vocabulary activity for middle school students.”*

C *“Design a 10-minute browser-based activity for approximately 30 Korean Grade 8 EFL learners at A2–B1 level. The goal is to help them understand six target expressions in context and use them appropriately. Students will work individually on one device each. After an incorrect first attempt, give a hint rather than the answer and allow one retry.”*

C isn't better because it sounds more like a prompt.

It's better because the instructional context is clearer.

7 Elements of Context



Learner & Proficiency

L Learner

Who are they?

Approximately 30 Korean Grade 8 EFL learners in a regular English class.

P Proficiency

What can they already do?

Most are approximately A2–B1. They know the basic meanings of the target expressions but have difficulty using them in context.

AI cannot infer what your students already know.

Learning Goal

What should change in the learner?

BAD
“Teach vocabulary.”

BETTER
“Help students learn six expressions.”

GOOD
“Help students understand the six expressions in context and select or use them appropriately in short situations.”

If the learning goal changes, shouldn't the activity change too?

Content & Time / Task

C Content

What exactly should AI work with?

- target vocabulary
- reading passage
- grammar feature
- source text

Use only the six target expressions and the source passage provided below.

T Time & Task

What must the activity actually look like?

- 10 minutes
- individual
- browser-based
- six items

The activity should take approximately 10 minutes and be completed individually in a browser.

Constraints & Feedback

X Constraints

What is realistically possible?

30 students | one device each | no login | school Wi-Fi

If AI gives a great idea the school can't run, is it still good design?

F Feedback

What should happen while the learner is learning?

immediate answer? | hint? | retry? | explanation?

Feedback audit (피드백 점검).

25–45 MIN · PUTTING IT TOGETHER

The Instructional Context Brief

L	**Learner**	*Who?*
P	**Proficiency**	*What can they already do?*
G	**Goal**	*What should they learn?*
C	**Content**	*With what material?*
T	**Time & Task**	*How long, what output?*
X	**Constraints**	*What's realistically possible?*
F	**Feedback**	*How should learning be supported?*

Context is not more information.
It is the right information for the instructional decision.

What's Missing?

“Create a fun reading activity for high school students.”

What important context is missing?

grade | proficiency | reading text | goal

duration | interaction | feedback | device/class setting

90–103 MIN · INDIVIDUAL CONTEXT REDESIGN

Turn a Prompt into an Instructional Brief

Generic prompt: *“Create an English reading activity.”*

1. Choose a real or imagined class of yours. → 2. Fill in the seven context items below. → 3. Turn it into one instructional request.

Context	My Decision
Learner	
Proficiency	
Goal	
Content	
Time / Task	
Constraints	
Feedback	

Don't ask AI to design your lesson before you have designed the problem.

75–90 MIN · ONE IMPORTANT LIMIT

AI Self-Review Does Not Replace Teacher Review



AI evaluating its own output is still generation — not judgment.

103–107 MIN · COMPARE & SHARE

What Makes Context Good?

1. **Specific**
   Is it clear what you want?

2. **Relevant**
   Is it information the decision actually needs?

3. **Coherent**
   Do learner–goal–activity–feedback fit together?

4. **Feasible**
   Is it actually possible in a real classroom?

Longer is not better.
More pedagogically informative is better.



10-Minute Break